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hypothesis

Vanderpool

■ What is it?

Vanderpool is the codename for the hardware technology that Intel expects to build into its processors in 5 years. These processors will be able to run several operating systems simultaneously on a single computer.

■ What does it do?

Operating Systems are the gatekeepers of a computer's hardware, giving access to applications as required. Running more than one operating system is not possible without additional software that creates a virtual machine. Vanderpool allows you to create virtual machines within the processor itself.

■ How does it work?

Vanderpool does not eliminate the need to run virtualization software, but it does make it simpler. It creates a hyper-OS on top of which other OSes can run. Hence you can run several versions of Windows, along with Linux.

snapshot

Skype, a tool to make free calls, was downloaded **1.3 million** times since its launch on **Aug 29th 2003**

Source: Skype

India, China the rising stars: Intel Chairman

Intel's Chairman, Andrew S Grove, observed that India and China dominates US in important high technology sectors. India's booming software industry, which is increasingly doing work for US companies, is capable of surpassing America in software and technology service sectors by 2010. He said that US's software and service businesses are under siege by countries such as India and China, who have the advantage of cheap



ILLUSTRATOR: Farzana Cooper

labour costs and strong incentives for new financial investment.

According to industry figures, more than half a million technology jobs were lost from mid-2001 to mid-2003.

The Gartner Group estimates that 10 per cent of the jobs at US information technology vendors will move offshore by next 2004.

Phone check-mates grand master

Ruslan Ponomariov, a Ukrainian chess grandmaster, was disqualified during a match because his cell phone rang. The 20-year old Ponomariov was playing against the Swedish grand master M Evgeny Agrest at the European Team Championships, when a phone call ended it all. Mobile phones are banned during a game as a player can receive information, or access a computer database of possible moves. Ponomariov, the youngest World Champion of 2002, now earns the distinction of being the first person to be banned under the new law. Incidentally, it was also the day of his birthday. Ponomariov protested by refusing to sign in the score-sheets where the players are required to record their moves and the result of the match. The match was drawn with the score of 2-2.

Go ahead Rambus

"It's not over until the fat lady sings, and today, the fat lady sang", said Rambus general counsel John Danforth on 6th October, after the US Supreme court refused to hear



Infineon Technologies' appeal against Rambus. This clears the way for the chip maker to

prove that memory makers are violating its patents. Rambus stands to gain up to \$1 billion as royalty, if Infineon is proved

to have infringed the latter's intellectual property. The results

of this case will impact similar suits Rambus has filed against Hynix and Micron Technology.

Web search hogs

Web surfers find themselves redirected to unfamiliar Web sites, or find that their browser preferences have been changed without their knowledge. The domain registrar—VeriSign—attempted to redirect mistyped domain names to its own search page. In October 2003, a Trojan horse called QHosts, changed domain name system (DNS) settings to redirect visitors to such Web sites, as Google.com, to an alternate search site laced

with ads—all in the name of coveted Web search hits.

Google was deluged with complaints from Web surfers about their site being not reachable. Experts expect an increase in search hijacking attempts according to the given value of search traffic.

VeriSign's temporary experiment represents more fights to come. Even search engine and security consultants agree, saying other search attacks are sure to follow.

■ Sun release Solaris for AMD64 ■ Benchmarks indicate that the Big Mac—a supercomputer built using Power Mac G5—maybe the second fastest on Earth